

Drawing

Paul Klee (1879–1940) once wrote: ‘a drawing is simply a line going for a walk’. Using materials such as pencil, charcoal, ink or coloured pencil, drawing is one of the major forms of expression within the visual arts, with artists using methods including line, stippling, hatching and cross-hatching. After pencils were first manufactured early in the 19th century, they became the preferred drawing tools of many.

The earliest known drawings are found on cave walls dating from 30,000 BCE. Ancient Egyptian craftsmen and medieval artists made careful preparatory sketches and outlines for finished works. In the late 14th century, drawing became more important for itself, largely through the rise of naturalism instigated by artists such as Giotto and the Northern Renaissance artists’ detailed approach. Leonardo filled his notebooks with detailed, lifelike drawings and diagrams, while Dürer demonstrated his proficiency in detailed, intricate drawings, ultimately leading to drawing becoming considered the foundation for all the arts.



Leonardo, *The Virgin and Child with Saint Anne and Saint John the Baptist*, c.1500